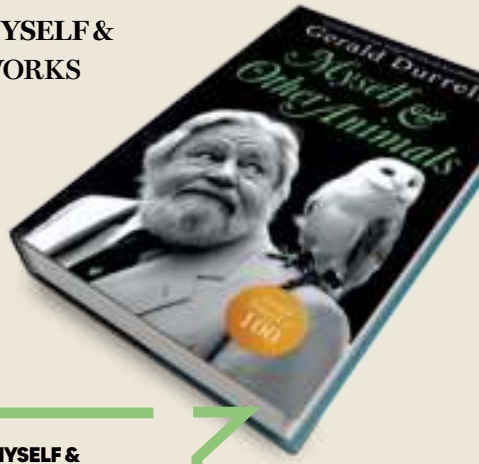
BOOKS ▶

Adrift on Noah's Ark

GERALD DURRELL'S POSTHUMOUS AUTOBIOGRAPHY, MYSELF & OTHER ANIMALS, IS AS DELIGHTFUL AS HIS OTHER WORKS

Published 30 years after his passing, and in his centenary year, *Myself & Other Animals* should revive interest in naturalist Gerald Durrell's legacy. Jamshedpur-born Durrell's childhood was spent in a wild rapture. Happily for his readers, he never grew up. In 1930, following his father's death, his mother Louisa moved with her four children (including eldest son Lawrence, later another famous writer) to England. But the India-raised Durrells couldn't cope with life there. The family followed Lawrence to Corfu, a Greek island where young Gerald spent an idyllic Mediterranean boyhood among creatures great and small. There he met his natural history mentor, the polymath Theodore Stephanides. These recollections would appear, garnished with saucy humour and serendipity, in the bestselling Corfu Trilogy—*My Family and Other Animals; Birds, Beasts and Rela-*



MYSELF & OTHER ANIMALS
By Gerald Durrell
PENGUIN VIKING
₹1,399; 352 pages

THE LISTICLE

Recent book releases which should be on your reading list



SPIES, LIES AND ALLIES
By Kavitha Rao
WESTLAND
₹499; 272 pages

THE CHIEF MINISTER AND THE SPY
By A.S. Dulat
JUGGERNAUT
₹799; 312 pages

Secrets and Shadows

Intrigue and espionage seem to be the flavour of the season. Kavitha Rao's *Spies, Lies and Allies* is the extraordinary tale of two Indian revolutionaries—Virendranath Chattopadhyaya a.k.a. Chatto (Sarojini Naidu's brother) and M.N. Roy, who founded the Tashkent group of the Communist Party of India—as they dodge the British secret service in their journey through Europe. The author of the much-lauded *Lady Doctors* has pulled off another coup with this dual biography which has no dearth of interesting encounters. And making waves since its launch is former RAW chief A.S Dulat's book which sheds light on his unlikely alliance with then J&K chief minister Farooq Abdullah through truly challenging times.